The Basket Team Story: Highlights

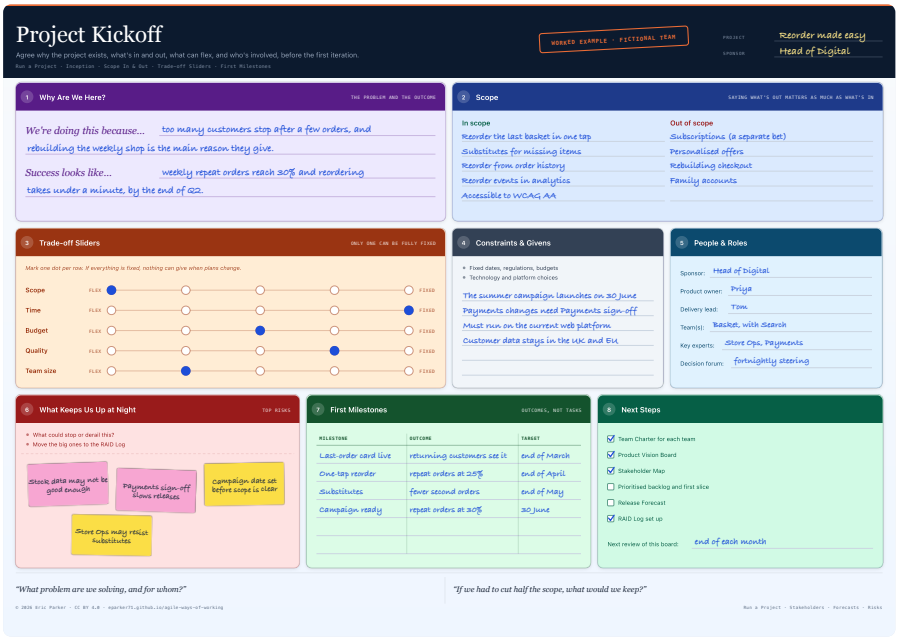
Twelve moments from the Basket team's five months, each with the lesson it teaches. One fictional team at an online grocery service, from kickoff to close-out. Each step opens the filled-in board. This is the short version. The full story has all 66 worked examples, in order.

Online, with every board full size: eparker71.github.io/agile-ways-of-working/basket-team-highlights.html

The cast. The Basket team: Priya (product owner), Sam and Jo (developers), Alex (tester), Mei (designer), Tom (Scrum Master), and Ravi (developer, from March). Around them: the Head of Digital (sponsor), and the Checkout, Payments, Search & Browse, Store Platform and Warehouse teams. **The goal:** make the weekly shop effortless, so repeat orders rise from 22% to 30%.

February · Getting started

3 Feb

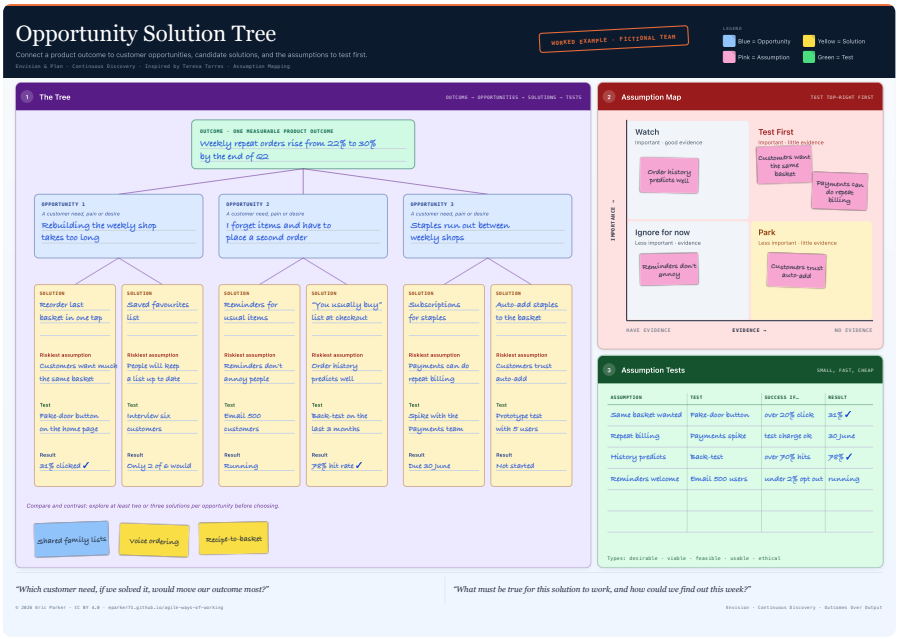


Project Kickoff

The Head of Digital sponsors “Reorder made easy”: repeat orders from 22% to 30% by the end of June, with only the campaign date fixed.

Lesson: Agree what can flex before you start. Here only the date was fixed, so scope could give.

12 Feb



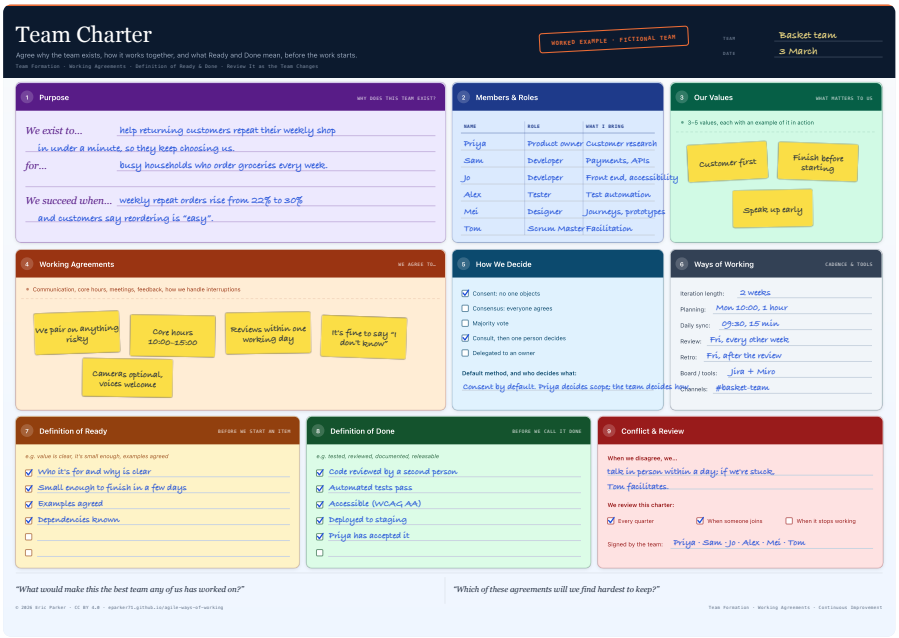
Opportunity Solution Tree

One outcome, three opportunities, six solutions. A fake-door button shows 31% of customers want one-tap reorder.

Lesson: Test the riskiest assumption cheaply, before building anything.

March · Forming the team

3 Mar

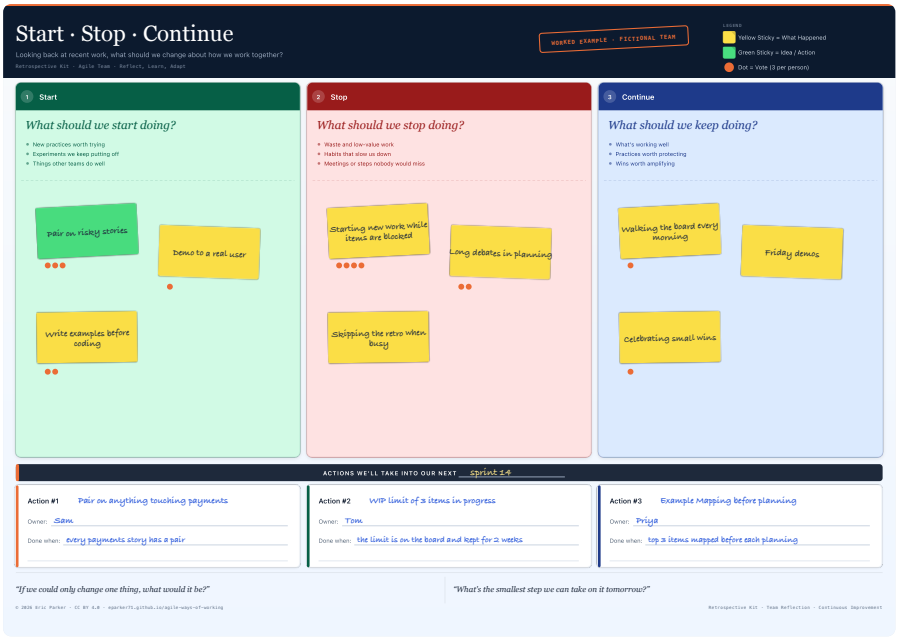


Team Charter

The Basket team agrees its purpose, values, working agreements and Definitions of Ready and Done.

Lesson: Working agreements written on day one save arguments in month three.

14 Mar



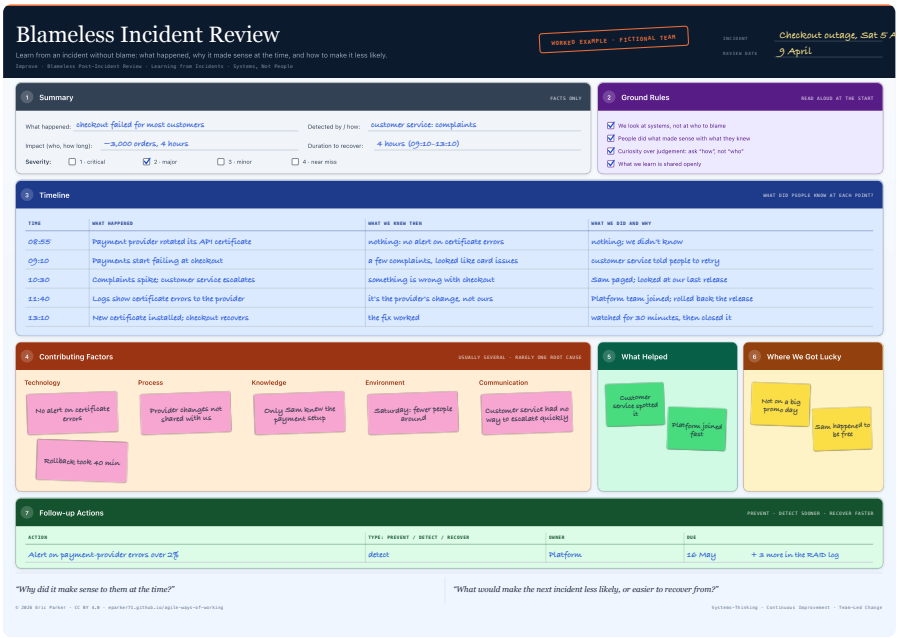
Start · Stop · Continue

Sprint 14's retro: stop starting new work while items are blocked; try Example Mapping before planning.

Lesson: A retro is only as good as its actions: each one has an owner and a "done when".

April · Delivering, and the first knocks

9 Apr

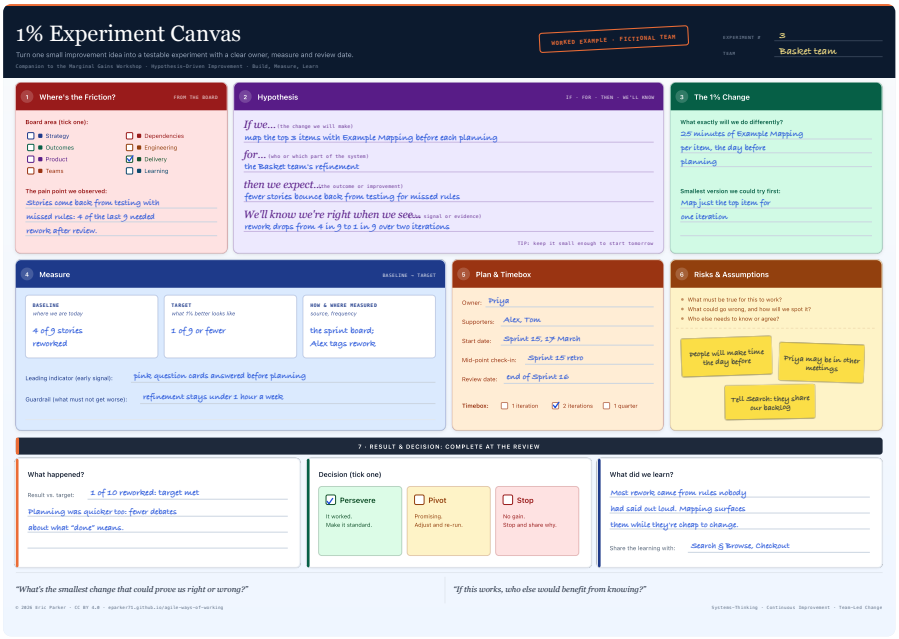


Blameless Incident Review

Saturday 5 April: checkout fails for four hours. The blameless review finds no alert on certificate errors.

Lesson: Ask why it made sense at the time. Fix the system, not the person.

11 Apr

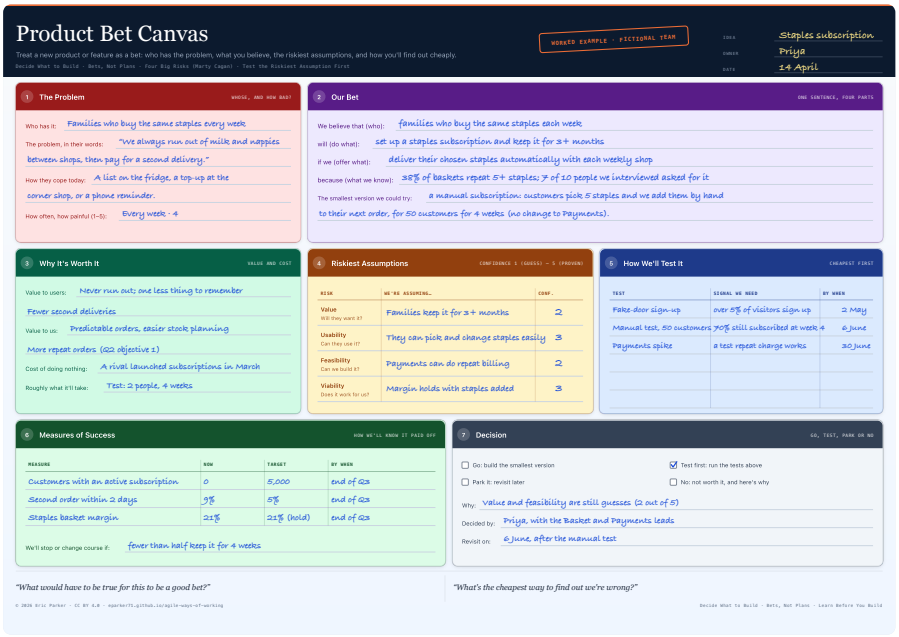


1% Experiment Canvas

Example Mapping before planning worked: rework fell from 4 in 9 stories to 1 in 10.

Lesson: Small, measured experiments turn retro ideas into evidence.

14 Apr

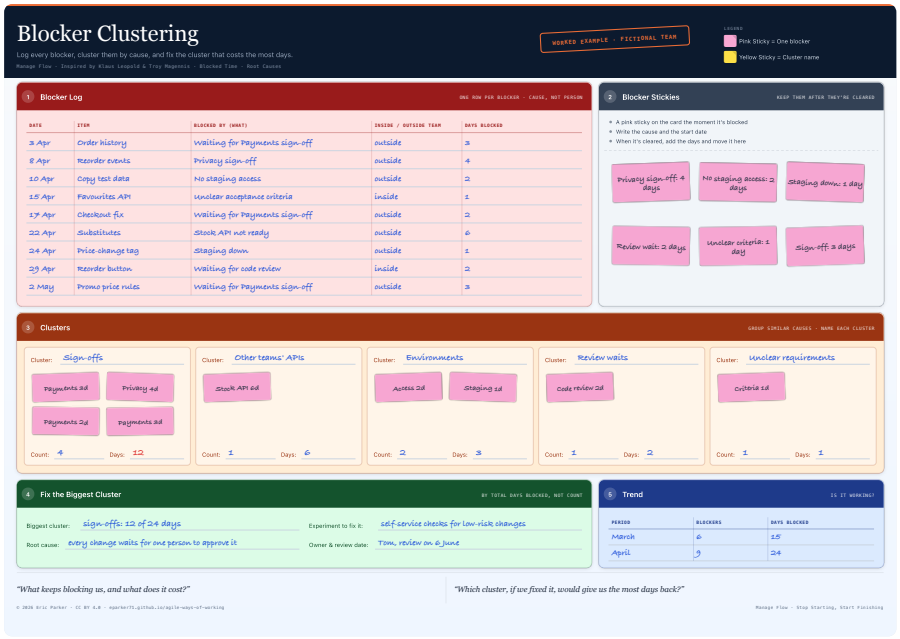


Product Bet Canvas

The staples subscription bet: test it by hand with 50 customers before building anything.

Lesson: Treat big ideas as bets with a stop rule, not as plans.

5 May

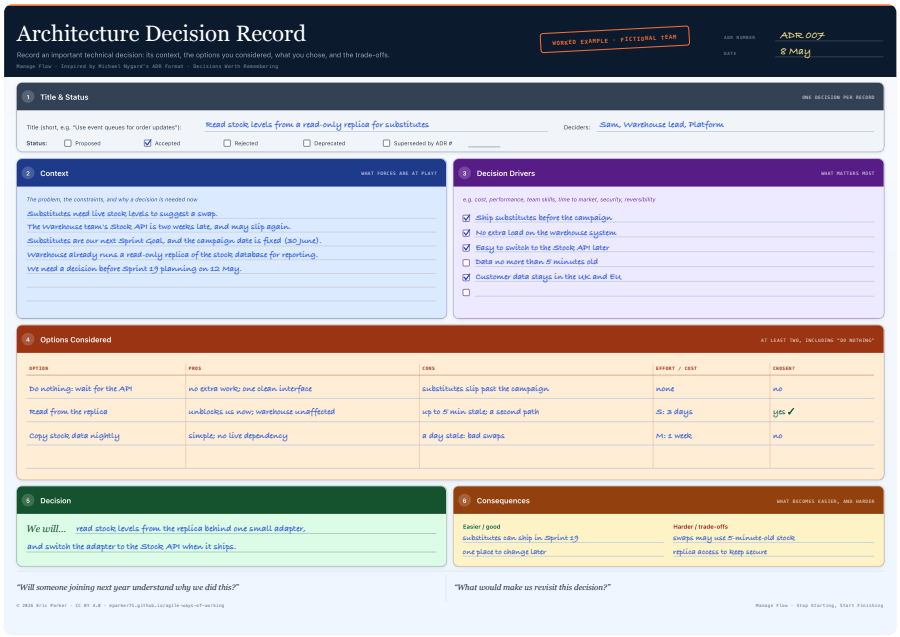


Blocker Clustering

April's blockers clustered: sign-offs cost 12 of 24 blocked days, so that's the one to fix.

Lesson: Count blocked days, not blockers: one cause, sign-offs, cost half of them.

8 May

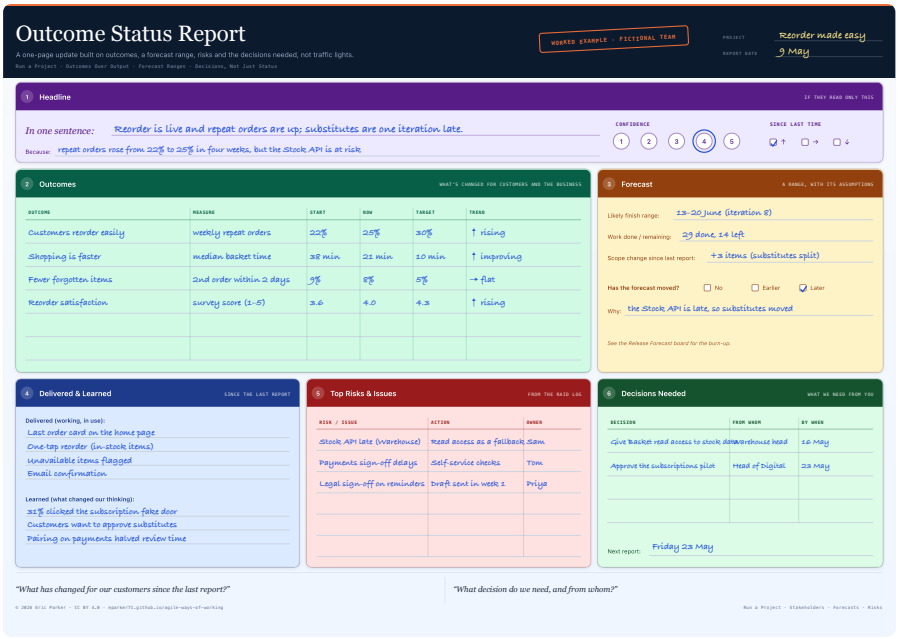


Architecture Decision Record

ADR 007: read stock levels from a replica behind an adapter, and switch to the API when it ships.

Lesson: Write down why you chose, so the next person doesn't have to argue it again.

9 May



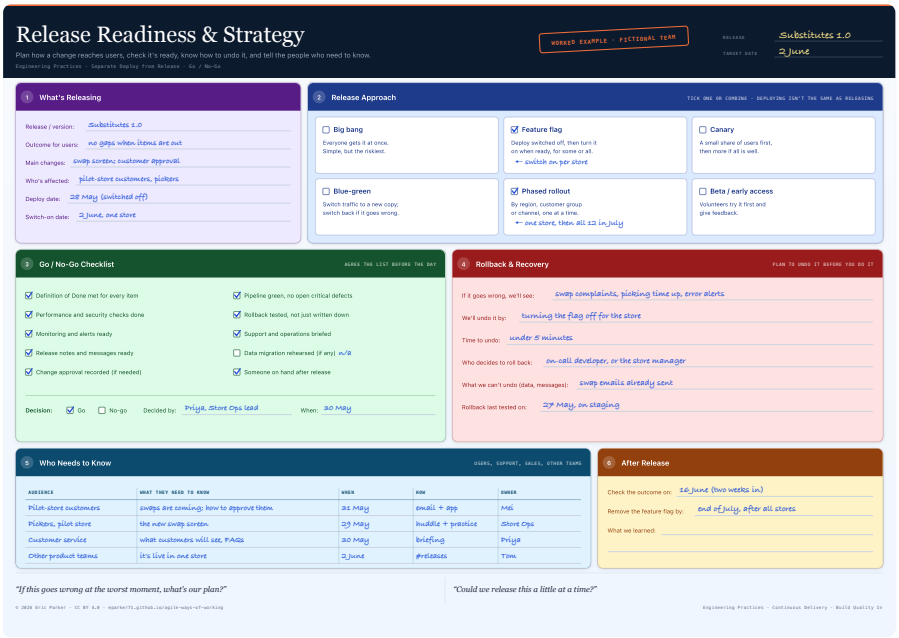
Outcome Status Report

Amber: reorder is live and repeat orders are at 25%, but substitutes are an iteration late.

Lesson: Report outcomes and a forecast range, and ask for the decisions you need.

June · Shipping

2 June



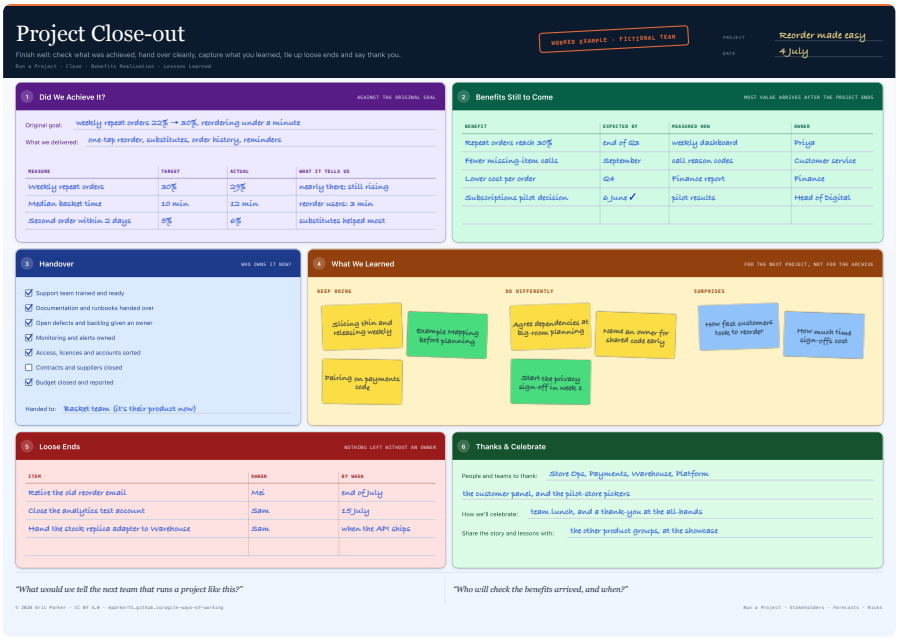
Release Readiness & Strategy

Substitutes 1.0 switches on in one store, behind a feature flag, with a tested rollback.

Lesson: Separate deploying from releasing, and test the rollback before you need it.

July · Finishing well

4 July



Project Close-out

Repeat orders reached 29%, nearly the 30% target. The team hands over, thanks people and records what it learned.

Lesson: Most of the value arrives after the project ends, so name who will check it.

All names, numbers and events are made up, but the problems are real ones. For the tools grouped by job instead of by date, see the worked examples gallery; for situations rather than a story, see the Scenario Playbook.

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